THE HIT MACHINE

RISHABH PANT, 24

Cricketer, **Roorkee**



"Pant has produced three innings that changed the course of a Test... most players don't contribute that many in a career"

IAN CHAPPELL
Ex-Australia captain

MICHAEL BRADLEY/ GETTY IMAGES

Rishabh Pant first came into the Indian side as an understudy to M.S. Dhoni. Pant got his opportunities, succeeded, failed and rose again. At just 24, he has already guided India to some famous victories. On the cricket field, he is a dangerous bat, a far improved wicketkeeper, and off the field he has become a sponsors' delight. That the opposition fears him was evident when earlier this year in Chennai, England delayed their second innings declaration in the first Test. One reason captain Joe Root cited was Pant: "If he bats for one session, it can make things quite interesting. I didn't want the pressure of having to contain as well as take wickets." This came just weeks after the left-hander had guided India to a famous victory at the Gabba in Brisbane to win the Test series 2-1 in Australia. He also leads the high-profile IPL team Delhi Capitals, who retained him for Rs 16 crore for the next three years.

–Rahul Rawat

TON UP Pant is the only Indian wicketkeeper-batsman to score a Test century in England and Australia